

Editorial restraint. Product clarity. Lifestyle energy.

A visual system for the Plazzaa customer experience, marketplace, merchant website and product interfaces. Built to feel internationally competitive, contemporary and unmistakably intentional.



“The website should feel designed, not decorated.”

1. Brand & visual direction

Plazzaa should feel like an international lifestyle technology brand - curious, editorial, refined, contemporary, human and confident. The customer-facing experience should feel exploratory and visual; the merchant product should inherit the same brand DNA while becoming more operational and precise.

Design principles

- Use whitespace as an active design element. Empty space is not a problem to solve.
- Let typography establish hierarchy before adding containers, borders or colour.
- Prefer photography, interaction and editorial composition over decorative tech graphics.
- Use asymmetry deliberately. Avoid template-like 50/50 layouts repeated section after section.
- Keep motion purposeful: it should reveal, connect or respond - never merely entertain.
- Product interfaces may be denser than the landing page, but should remain calm and readable.

Avoid

- Excessive gradients, glows, glassmorphism or neon startup aesthetics.
- Heavy shadows, oversized rounded cards and pill-shaped UI everywhere.
- Putting every piece of content inside a card.

Generic stock photography or overly polished restaurant-ad imagery.

Overusing blue or yellow simply because they are brand colours.

Dense sections with little vertical rhythm or identical section heights.

2. Colour system

The interface should remain predominantly neutral. Plazzaa Blue is the primary brand and interaction colour. Plazzaa Yellow is the second primary brand colour, used for personality and selective emphasis. Neutral Grey and Ink form the secondary palette, while Soft Grey, Soft Lavender and Warm Cream form the tertiary palette.

Token	Hex	Role	Recommended usage
Plazzaa Blue	#2D60EA	Primary - brand + interaction	Primary CTAs, links, selected states, sliders, active controls
Plazzaa Yellow	#FCD451	Primary - brand accent	Selective highlights, editorial annotations, pricing emphasis, memorable discovery moments
Neutral Grey	#A1A1AA	Secondary - subdued UI	Disabled/inactive UI, metadata, subtle separators - not standard body text
Plazzaa Ink	#18181B	Secondary - text + structure	Headlines, body emphasis, navigation, dark sections and high-contrast structure
Soft Grey	#F4F4F5	Tertiary - neutral surface	Subtle surfaces, search backgrounds and functional groupings
Soft Lavender	#EDE9FE	Tertiary - editorial surface	Selected editorial moments, budget/planner sections and soft visual contrast
Warm Cream	#FFFBEB	Tertiary - lifestyle surface	Experiences, human storytelling and warmer editorial transitions
White	#FFFFFF	Utility - primary canvas	Dominant page background and breathing space
Secondary Body	#52525B	Utility - readable support text	Default secondary copy; use instead of #A1A1AA for readability

Colour distribution

60-70% White / neutral canvas
 15-20% Ink + grey typography
 8-12% Plazzaa Blue
 3-5% Warm Yellow
 5-10% Lavender / cream support surfaces

Blue should primarily signal interaction: something can be clicked, selected, dragged, activated or explored. Yellow is also a primary brand colour, but should behave like punctuation in the interface: memorable, sparing and never the dominant infrastructure colour.

3. Typography

Use a dual-type system: a clean product sans for almost everything, and a selective editorial serif for expressive moments. The contrast should feel sophisticated, not ornamental.

Primary sans - Manrope

Use for navigation, body copy, buttons, forms, marketplace UI, merchant UI, labels and most headings. Recommended weights: 400 Regular, 500 Medium, 600 SemiBold, 700 Bold.

Editorial display - Instrument Serif

Use sparingly for hero words, emotional statements, editorial transitions and selected numbers. Do not use it for long body copy, forms or dense product UI.

Fallbacks for implementation

```
font-family: Manrope, Inter, system-ui, -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", sans-serif;
font-family: "Instrument Serif", "EB Garamond", Georgia, serif;
```

Desktop type scale

Usage	Size	Line height	Weight
Hero XL	88–104px	0.94–1.00	500
Hero	72–84px	0.98	500
H1	64px	1.02	500–600
H2	48px	1.08	500
H3	36px	1.15	500
H4	26px	1.25	600
Large body	22px	1.55	400
Body	18px	1.55	400
Small body	15px	1.50	400
Label	13px	1.30	600

Button	15–16px	1.00	600
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Mobile type scale

Hero 46–54px • H1 42px • H2 34px • H3 28px • H4 22px
 Large body 18px • Body 16px • Small 14px • Label 12–13px

Type rules

Do not make every headline bold. Prefer medium weight + scale + whitespace.

Landing-page paragraphs should generally sit within 45–65 characters per line.

Hero copy may span 800–1,050px on large desktop screens.

Use sentence case. Avoid all-caps headlines; reserve uppercase for compact labels/eyebrows.

Mobile hero line-height: 0.98–1.06. Body line-height: 1.50–1.65.

4. Layout, grid & page edges

Plazzaa should feel close to the viewport edges, especially on desktop. Avoid the conventional narrow 1200px SaaS container. Content can be wide while readable text blocks remain intentionally constrained.

Horizontal page padding

≥1600px: 40px outer padding, max content width 1800px
 1280–1599px: 32px
 1024–1279px: 28px
 768–1023px: 24px
 640–767px: 20px
 0–639px: 16–20px

Grid

Desktop: 12-column fluid grid
 Gutter: 20–24px
 Margin: follows page padding
 Prefer asymmetry: e.g. headline cols 1–7 / interaction cols 7–12

Do not repeat 6-column / 6-column split layouts throughout the site. Use varied compositions, offsets and deliberate negative space.

5. Spacing & breathing room

Use an 8px base spacing system with 4px increments where necessary. Landing pages should breathe more than dashboards and transactional flows.

Core spacing tokens

4 • 8 • 12 • 16 • 20 • 24 • 32 • 40 • 48 • 64 • 80 • 96 • 120 • 160 • 200 px

Recommended relationships

Icon → text: 8px
 Label → input: 8px
 Heading → supporting copy: 20–24px
 Paragraph → CTA: 28–32px
 Card internal padding: 24–32px desktop / 18–20px mobile
 Card → card: 16–24px
 Small section separation: 64–80px
 Major landing-page section separation: 120–160px
 Large editorial transition: 160–220px
 Major statement → next content: 48–80px

Section rhythm

Do not make every section the same height. Alternate intimate sections with cinematic ones. A typical landing-page rhythm may move through 120px, 200px, 96px, 160px and 220px transitions rather than repeating one token.

6. Component language

Border radius

Small controls 8px
 Inputs 10px
 Buttons 10–12px
 Standard cards 14px
 Large visual cards 18–24px
 Pills 999px - only when the object is genuinely a pill/tag

Buttons

Primary height: 48–52px
 Horizontal padding: 20–24px
 Radius: 10px
 Typography: Manrope 15–16px / 600

Use Plazaa Blue or Ink for primary actions. Secondary buttons should be transparent/white with subtle borders. Editorial CTAs may be text-only: “Explore experiences ↗”. Not every action needs a filled button.

Cards

Business cards: photography-led, with information feeling attached to the image rather than trapped in a heavy container.

Editorial cards: may use colour surfaces, usually without shadow.

Interactive cards: subtle border and selected-state feedback.

Functional product cards: white surface + 1px #E4E4DF-style border treatment; minimal shadow.

Avoid white-card + shadow + rounded-corner repetition across every section.

Inputs & search

Height: 48–52px
 Radius: 10px
 Padding X: 14–16px
 Border: 1px solid neutral border
 Focus: 2px Plazaa Blue

Icons

Use one consistent outlined icon family with 1.5–2px stroke, rounded joins and 20–24px standard size. A Lucide-style system is appropriate. Do not mix filled, outlined and illustrated icon families.

7. Navigation & Plazaa gateway controls

Desktop navigation

Height: 72–80px
 Horizontal padding: 32px
 Keep visually light and low-chrome

Recommended structure: PLAZZAA / Discover / Experiences / For Business ... Log in / Explore Plazaa →

Sticky customer / merchant gateway

Use a persistent floating navigation element so visitors can move between the consumer and merchant propositions without losing context. It should feel like a product control, not a banner.

Desktop height: 56–64px
 Radius: 16px
 Internal padding: 6px
 Customer path: “Looking for somewhere to go? Explore places →”
 Merchant path: “Run a business? Plazaa for Business →”

On mobile, simplify to two compact actions in a bottom-safe layout. Avoid technical labels such as “Customer” and “Merchant” as the primary CTA language; describe user intent instead.

8. Photography & visual direction

Photography should make Plazaa feel like an editorial city/lifestyle brand, not an advertising flyer. Let the imagery carry much of the colour on predominantly neutral pages.

Prefer genuine environments and people actually interacting.

Use slightly imperfect framing, movement and natural light where appropriate.

Mix architectural, food/detail, nightlife and human-context photography.

Avoid generic smiling stock groups, over-retouched restaurant images and overly saturated lifestyle scenes.

Use varied crops: 4:5 portrait, 3:2 editorial landscape, 16:9 wide, 5:4 feature and 1:1 square.

9. Motion & interaction

Motion should make the landing page feel exploratory and alive. It should reveal relationships, respond to input or transform one state into another. Avoid motion that exists only to show technical ability.

Recommended motion

Cards lift 2–4px maximum on hover.

Image hover scale: 1.00 → 1.025.

Use sticky storytelling, horizontal galleries and progressive reveals where appropriate.

Allow interactive questions (budget, category, location, occasion) to visibly change content around them.

Use parallax carefully and respect reduced-motion preferences.

Timing

Micro interaction: 160–220ms

Interface transition: 280–400ms

Editorial / scroll storytelling: 500–800ms

Preferred easing: cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)

10. Landing-page composition rules

The homepage should feel like a usable preview of Plazzaa, not a conventional SaaS hero followed by feature cards. Make the first viewport an interactive lifestyle discovery moment.

Hero direction

Where could today take you?

Surround the statement with interactive lifestyle inputs and responsive destination cards: location, category, budget, occasion and experience. The user should understand within seconds that Plazzaa helps them discover places and plan around what they want to spend.

Recommended visual ratio

50% visual experience

25% typography / storytelling

15% interactive product demonstration

10% conventional UI

Do not build

Headline → paragraph → two buttons → dashboard screenshot
(repeated as a generic SaaS hero template)

11. Responsive philosophy

Mobile should be recomposed, not merely compressed. Desktop uses wide spatial compositions; mobile becomes vertical editorial storytelling.

Mobile page padding: 16–20px

Section spacing: 72–96px

Large section transition: 120px

Card gap: 12–16px

Hero: 46–52px

Breakpoints

0–639px	Mobile
640–767px	Large mobile / small tablet
768–1023px	Tablet
1024–1279px	Laptop
1280–1599px	Desktop
1600px+	Large desktop

Occasional full-bleed imagery is encouraged on mobile to create editorial rhythm. Do not waste narrow screens with oversized side padding.

12. Product UI: marketplace + merchant dashboard

The marketplace and merchant dashboard should inherit the same typography, colour logic and spacing language, but become more functional. The landing page may be expressive; operational interfaces should prioritise clarity, speed and consistency.

Use Manrope for all dense product UI.

Reserve Instrument Serif for marketing/editorial moments; generally exclude it from dashboard tables, booking forms and settings.

Use Plazzaa Blue for selected, active and primary actions; do not use it as indiscriminate background decoration.

Keep form components 48–52px tall with clear focus states and predictable spacing.

Use cards only when they communicate grouping or hierarchy; tables/lists can sit directly on the page.

Treat mobile as a first-class layout, especially for merchant booking management and customer booking links.

13. Implementation directive for Claude

Follow the Plazzaa design system strictly. Build an editorial, internationally competitive lifestyle brand rather than a generic SaaS or local-startup aesthetic. Use Manrope as the primary interface typeface and Instrument Serif selectively for expressive display text. Keep desktop layouts close to the viewport edges with approximately 32px horizontal margins and mobile layouts at 16–20px. Use generous whitespace, asymmetric compositions, large typography and photography-led layouts. Avoid excessive cards, gradients, shadows, coloured blobs, pill-shaped components and overly rounded UI. Plazzaa Blue (#2D60EA) is the primary brand and interaction colour. Plazzaa Yellow (#FCD451) is the second primary brand colour and should be used selectively for emphasis and personality, never as the dominant infrastructure colour. Use #18181B as primary ink, #52525B for secondary body copy, #A1A1AA only for genuinely subdued UI, #F4F4F5 for neutral surfaces, #EDE9FE for soft interaction/editorial surfaces, #FFFBEB for warm lifestyle/editorial moments and #FFFFFF as the dominant canvas. Sections should have generous vertical spacing and varied rhythms rather than identical template sections. Use subtle, purposeful motion and make the website feel exploratory, editorial and alive. Whenever typography or whitespace can establish hierarchy, prefer them over additional containers or decoration.

14. Quick reference

Primary font	Manrope
Editorial font	Instrument Serif
Primary - Blue	#2D60EA
Primary - Yellow	#FCD451
Secondary - Grey	#A1A1AA
Secondary - Ink	#18181B
Tertiary - Soft Grey	#F4F4F5
Tertiary - Lavender	#EDE9FE
Tertiary - Cream	#FFFBEB
Desktop edge	32px
Mobile edge	16–20px
Base spacing	8px
Button height	48–52px
Input height	48–52px
Primary radius	10–14px
Desktop grid	12-column / 20–24px gutter

Plazzaa should feel alive, not busy. Premium, not precious. Playful, not childish.